

THE COURT OF THE DRAGON

CAMPAIGN PLAY — THE LONG HUNGER

Version 0.5 · provisional. Recovered from session history and never yet played through a full campaign. All rates in this document are dials, not settled numbers.

THE LONG HUNGER

The following replaces the Trauma Step for a Court of the Dragon Warband. All other Campaign Phase steps are unchanged. The herd — the Bled and the Strix — are mortal, and live and die by the standard rules.

THE THIRST

Court vampires do not die, and their flesh does not scar — but every unmaking feeds the hunger, and the hunger keeps what it takes.

An ELITE vampire never rolls on the Trauma Table and never gains Battle Scars. Instead, in the Trauma Step, if the vampire was taken **Out of Action during the game**, it gains 1 **Thirst Marker**. Thirst is permanent unless quenched (see The Vintage). A vampire that was not taken Out of Action gains no Thirst.

- **1 Thirst — Fraying.** The vampire becomes Blood-Crazed at **4+ Sated** instead of 5+. (*The Voivode's Master of the Hunger still holds — outwardly, he shows nothing. Yet.*)
- **2 Thirst — Slipping.** Halve the model's Leash ranges: if it has DOMINION, the Leash it projects is halved; while it is Blood-Crazed, the range within which a friendly DOMINION model can control it is halved.
- **3 Thirst — Lost.** The hunger takes the last of the man. Replace the model's entry on your Warband Roster with a **Shrike** — same figure, nothing left inside it. Its Experience and Skills are gone; its Battlekit is moved to your Arsenal unless it cannot be removed. It keeps nothing but the face.

If the Voivode is Lost: promote one Boyar in the Warband to Voivode — swap its entry, keeping its Experience, Skills, and any Battlekit it can legally carry — or recruit a new Voivode at the Quartermaster Step. The Court is never long without a master.

TORPOR

The Shrike and the Leech make Survival Rolls as normal Troops, but on a 1-2 they are not removed from your roster — they enter **Torpor** and miss the next battle while the grave-soil remakes them.

THE VINTAGE

When your Warband collects Loot in the Exploration Step, you may take any portion of it as **Vintage** instead of ducats, at a rate of **10👑 = 1 Vintage** — the Court drains the living it finds rather than looting the dead. Record Vintage on your Warband Roster. Vintage cannot be spent on Battlekit, Glory Items, or recruits.

Quenching the Thirst: in the Quartermaster Step, you may spend **10 Vintage** to remove 1 Thirst Marker from one vampire. A Warband may do this no more than **once per Campaign Phase**. The lord is carried down to the grave-soil, and the herd pays for what comes back up.

DESIGN NOTES

Why the Court needs its own campaign layer. Every other faction's campaign arc bends toward the grave — Battle Scars accumulate to Unfit for Duty at 3, and a bad Survival Roll kills outright. The Court opts out of

mortality by design, so death cannot be its stake. Something else has to erode, and the only thing left is the self. The campaign question for a Court player is not *will my champion survive?* but *will he still be him?*

Why Vintage buys nothing else. Ducats grow the Court; blood preserves it. Vintage deliberately has exactly one use — there is no blood-shop, because that is Glory's lane. Taking Loot as Vintage is a real sacrifice of roster growth, which is what makes quenching a decision rather than an errand.

Why Troops enter Torpor. The lords are eternal and the cattle are spent — that is the faction thesis stated in campaign form. Torpor costs a model one battle and no bookkeeping beyond a note on the roster. The herd staying fully mortal is the other half of the same point.

Provisional dials, in the order I'd expect to change them: the 10:1 Loot conversion, the 10-Vintage quench cost, the once-per-Campaign-Phase cap, and whether a Lost vampire's replacement Shrike should retain anything at all. The first full campaign decides.

INTERACTIONS WITH V0.10

The Cask Cart (Glory Item, 3*) is the only other source of Vintage: at the end of each game, each friendly Bled on the battlefield carrying 1 or more BLOOD MARKERS yields 1 Vintage, to a maximum of 3 per game. That makes the Cart a partial substitute for converting Loot, and it deliberately pulls against the in-game incentives — *Cattle* pays Sated when a Bled dies, and *Offer the Vein* risks killing the Bled every time you drink. Tempo now versus a quenched Thirst later.

Nothing else in v0.10 touches this section. The Yoke of the Herd and the Grave-Damp Sprayer both encourage spending Bled during a game, which reduces Cask Cart income; that tension is intended.